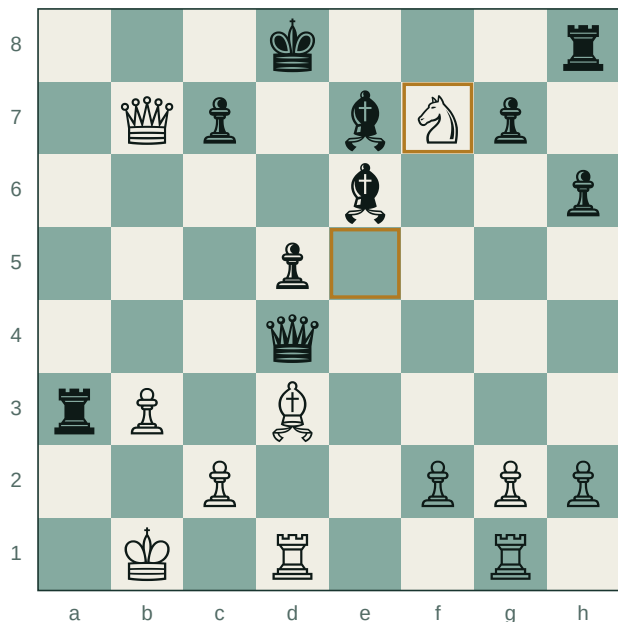


Loose-piece tactics: Black, move 28

Loose-piece tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 28.Nxf7+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

28...Bxf7 29. Qb8+ Kd7 30. Bb5+ Kd6 31. Qxc7+ Kxc7

28...Bxf7 The bishop captures the knight on f7. Recorded reply: **29.Qb8+**.

29...Kd7 The king moves from d8 to d7. The changed line means the rook on h8 attacks the queen on b8. Recorded reply: **30.Bb5+**.

30...Kd6 The king moves from d7 to d6. Recorded reply: **31.Qxc7+**.

31...Kxc7 The king captures the queen on c7.

At the end, nominal material is White 18 / Black 28 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +11. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +11:** the balance goes from -1 to +10. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A piece may appear hanging because its defender is indirect: taking it might allow mate, a fork, or a stronger capture.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An undefended or tactically undefendable piece can turn an ordinary position into a combination. The first task is to distinguish a truly free capture from a poisoned one.

HOW TO LOOK

List the loose enemy pieces and check whether a forcing move can expose or attack more than one of them.

The defending king is on b1. Geometrically undefended: knight on f7 and queen on b7. Check for tactical protection.